

Originally Processed With FOIA(s):  
2009-0275-S

FOIA Number:  
2009-0275-S

# FOIA MARKER

**This is not a textual record. This is used as an  
administrative marker by the George Bush Presidential  
Library Staff.**

---

**Record Group/Collection:** George H.W. Bush Presidential Records  
**Collection/Office of Origin:** Scowcroft, Brent, Collection  
**Series:** Presidential Correspondence Files  
**Subseries:** Presidential Telcon Files

---

**OA/ID Number:** 91113  
**Folder ID Number:** 91113-005

---

**Folder Title:**  
Presidential Telephone Calls - Memorandum of Conversations 7/10/92 - 11/5/92

---

| Stack:   | Row:      | Section: | Shelf:   | Position: |
|----------|-----------|----------|----------|-----------|
| <b>G</b> | <b>34</b> | <b>3</b> | <b>1</b> | <b>7</b>  |

---

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~

CONFIDENTIAL

7716

THE WHITE HOUSE  
WASHINGTON

MEMORANDUM OF TELEPHONE CONVERSATION

SUBJECT: Telephone call between the President and  
Chancellor Helmut Kohl of Germany

PARTICIPANTS: The President  
Chancellor Helmut Kohl of Germany  
Interpreter: Harry Obst  
Notetaker: Tony Wayne, NSC

DATE, TIME: October 14, 1992, 9:05-9:19 a.m. (EDT)  
AND PLACE: Oval Office

The President: Helmut? (U)

Chancellor Kohl: George? (U)

The President: How are you? (U)

Chancellor Kohl: A lot of work, but I cope. Right now I'm  
preparing for Birmingham. Before we start on work, how are  
things going? (U)

The President: Well, we have a big uphill fight. But I feel  
confident. We're behind in the polls and it will be a struggle,  
but I'm still confident we will win. (U)

Chancellor Kohl: We do see that it is. (U)

The President: It's all on the economy. There is a lot of gloom  
and doom on the economy. There is nothing on foreign affairs.  
People act as if the world doesn't exist. (U)

Chancellor Kohl: Yes, that is a tendency you can see over here  
too. George, I want to hear it straight from the horse's mouth  
so to speak: What do you think will be the effect of a third  
candidate? (U)

The President: Well, we don't believe that we're damaged. There  
may be some change, but in the final analysis it will come out of  
Clinton more than us. But that is hard to prove. We'll have to  
see. (e)

Chancellor Kohl: I'll keep my fingers crossed. (U)

The President: I'm calling about our favorite subject, the  
Uruguay Round. Andriessen thought our offers were constructive  
and said he would try to get McSharry and Delors to support them.  
So now we hope we can get the EC Commission to close the gap on

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~

Declassify on: OADR

CONFIDENTIAL

DECLASSIFIED  
PER E.O. 13526  
2009-0741-MR  
E8 4/6/15



~~CONFIDENTIAL~~

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~  
2

the remaining issues. This means that we need political will. I understand French domestic problems. They have been open in their warnings that the time is not ripe for a U.S.-EC understanding to move things forward on the Round. I suspect Francois may have raised his concerns with you but I think we both agree he's wrong to oppose an agreement this year at a time when we most need an accord to restore confidence and to get our economies moving forward. We've responded, we think, Helmut, to all the EC concerns -- on agriculture, market access, financial services and other areas. We've gone beyond what I originally authorized our negotiators to do in the early stages, beyond our bottom line. (S)

But what I really think is that you as the clear leader can do it. I know this won't be easy given Francois' position, but there's got to be a way to authorize EC negotiators to reach an understanding with ours. If we don't move now we are probably foreclosing the possibility of a Round agreement for the foreseeable future. It will be clear that there is not political will to succeed. This would be a devastating signal to send to the world economy and third world countries. (S)

The last point is, I'll send you a fairly detailed letter on our position and a short note to other EC leaders. But I would appreciate your thoughts on how next to proceed. (S)

Chancellor Kohl: George, thank you. It would be very important to have that letter by tomorrow noon our time. (U)

The President: That's easy. That's done. (U)

Chancellor Kohl: Secondly, I'd like to reiterate what I've said before. In view of the bad world economy a final GATT agreement would be more important than ever. My people have given me an interim report on the talks. I'll speak to a number of my colleagues, including Francois, on the margins of the summit. My intention would be to reconvene the U.S.-EC talks right after the Birmingham summit. (S)

I would like to take this opportunity, George, to say that I am very pleased how far the U.S. proceeded on other issues besides agriculture and this brought us all to this new favorable position. Two points that are very important. First is the problem with grain. The old positions were 18 percent and 24 percent. Here I would like to bring about a compromise. I will put all our efforts in this, but I'm not sure if we will be successful. The other point is cereal substitutes. The question is whether compromise is possible on substitutes. (S)

The President: On the first point, we have prepared a compromise and it will be in the letter I'm sending. (U)

Chancellor Kohl: On the substitute issue? (U)

The President: I think it is included, but do you have the details there in front of you of what you have in mind? (U)

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~

3

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~

Chancellor Kohl: According to what my people tell me, and I'm not in the negotiations, there's no movement on grain substitutes. We had discussed in Munich whether we could combine the grain and cereal substitute issues to try to establish a balance between substitutes and grain. (C)

The President: I think we reached an agreement on rebalancing, if that's what it is you are talking about. But I'll put something in the message on substitutes. (C)

Chancellor Kohl: If you could add a note on that, I'd appreciate it. (U)

The President: Well, that is all I have to say on the Round. I miss our contact. I'm too busy campaigning all the time. (U)

Chancellor Kohl: I have every understanding. Much courage and love to Barbara. (U)

The President: The same to you and Hanelore and the boys. (U)

- End of Conversation -

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~